



Imagine a little, cute creature with a hard shell and four tiny legs; yes, we're talking about the mud turtle! Mud turtles are small turtles that usually grow to about 3 to 4 inches long. They have a smooth, flat, and hard shell that is usually brown, black, or olive green. Their tiny feet are equipped with claws, and their head has a rather pointed snout with a beak-like mouth.



Now that we know how they look, let's dive into where these little guys love to hang out. Mud turtles can be found in a wide range of habitats but they especially love slow-moving freshwater environments. From marshes, ponds, to streams, these turtles love a good splash! They're even known to bury themselves in soft mud during the winter to keep warm.

Speaking of burying in mud, have you ever wondered about what these turtles munch on? Well, mud turtles are omnivores, meaning they eat both plants and animals. Their diet mainly consists of aquatic plants, small fish, insects, and even small frogs. They have strong jaws that help them grind their food, no matter how hard or slimy!



Just like us humans, mud turtles also have a very interesting life story. After the female mud turtle lays her eggs, she leaves them to hatch on their own. The little baby turtles, known as hatchlings, then have to fend for themselves right from the start. So, the next time you see a small, cute turtle, remember, it might just be a mud turtle, a little creature with a big life story!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) How long do mud turtles usually grow to be?
A. 3 to 4 inches long B. 7 to 8 inches long
C. 5 to 6 inches long D. 1 to 2 inches long
- 2) Where do mud turtles love to hang out?
A. Fast-flowing rivers B. Dry desert sand dunes
C. Slow-moving freshwater environments D. Rocky mountain streams
- 3) What does a mud turtle eat?
A. Only animals B. Only insects
C. Only plants D. Both plants and animals
- 4) What does a mud turtle's shell look like?
A. Bumpy and soft B. Spiked and rough
C. Smooth with spikes D. Smooth and flat
- 5) Where do mud turtles often bury themselves?
A. In thick snow B. Under tree roots C. In mud D. In warm sand
- 6) What color can a mud turtle's shell be?
A. White, gray, or yellow B. Orange, pink, or green
C. Red, blue, or purple D. Brown, black, or olive green
- 7) What does a female mud turtle do after she lays her eggs?
A. Leaves them to hatch on their own B. Takes them to water
C. Carries them around D. Stays and guards them
- 8) What is the name for a baby turtle?
A. Pup B. Cub C. Hatchling D. Chick
- 9) What time of the year do mud turtles bury themselves?
A. Spring B. Summer C. Winter D. Autumn
- 10) What type of snout does a mud turtle have?
A. A square snout B. A flat snout
C. A round snout D. A pointed snout

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "My shell is soft and squishy, not hard at all."
- 12) "I'm one of the biggest turtles, growing up to 6 feet long."
- 13) "I live in places like ponds and streams, where I can swim all day!"
- 14) "Did you know that I only grow up to 4 inches long, which is about as tall as a crayon?"
- 15) "During winter, I love to play in the snow."
- 16) "I detest the water, I prefer to stay on land."
- 17) "I can eat almost anything I find in the water, from fish to insects!"
- 18) "I only eat mud. That's how I got my name."



- 48) Mud turtles can't swim very fast.
A. can B. are not
C. will not D. cannot
- 49) They've got strong jaws that can crush shells.
A. They have B. They had
C. They will D. They are
- 50) They're known for their small size.
A. They were B. They is
C. They are D. They will

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 51) Mud turtles hibernate during the winter months.
- 52) Do mud turtles lay eggs?
- 53) Mud turtles eat insects, worms, and small fish.
- 54) Mud turtles are usually less than 5 inches long.
- 55) Are mud turtles endangered?
- 56) Do mud turtles hibernate?



Mud Turtle

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	A	26.	fact	51.	declarative
2.	C	27.	opinion	52.	interrogative
3.	D	28.	fact	53.	declarative
4.	D	29.	opinion	54.	declarative
5.	C	30.	fact	55.	interrogative
6.	D	31.	opinion	56.	interrogative
7.	A	32.	fact		
8.	C	33.	fact		
9.	C	34.	opinion		
10.	D	35.	opinion		
11.	Not	36.	true		
12.	Not	37.	false		
13.	Would	38.	true		
14.	Would	39.	false		
15.	Not	40.	true		
16.	Not	41.	false		
17.	Would	42.	false		
18.	Not	43.	false		
19.	Not	44.	true		
20.	Not	45.	true		
21.	Not	46.	B		
22.	Would	47.	A		
23.	Not	48.	D		
24.	Not	49.	A		
25.	Would	50.	C		